

EDUCATIA PLATFORM

Final Optimized Database Schema

11 Tables	3 Roles	Dynamic Dropdowns	Version
Final Optimized	Admin · Counsellor · Student	config_values — all dropdowns	June 2026

Column Type Legend

Type	Meaning	Type	Meaning
PK	Primary Key — unique row identifier	FK	Foreign Key — links to another table
student_id	The student this record BELONGS TO	user_id	Admin/Counsellor/Student who PERFORMED action
TINYINT(1)	Boolean — 0=false, 1=true	JSON	Stores structured data as JSON string
ENUM	Fixed system values only	config FK	Dynamic dropdown — references config_values
TIMESTAMP	Auto date-time field	DECIMAL	Precise number for money/scores

Standard End Sequence — All Tables

Tables WITH student	Tables WITHOUT student
student_id → user_id → created_at → updated_at	user_id → created_at → updated_at
applications, student_documents, student_accounts, visa_details, notifications	users, counsellors, config_values, leads, lead_educations, lead_activity_logs

All Tables — Quick Reference

#	Table	Purpose	student_id	user_id	Cols
1	users	Login accounts for admin, counsellor and student	■	■	10
2	counsellors	Extra HR details of counsellor staff members	■	■	14
3	config_values	Master dropdown table — all dynamic values	■	■	7
4	leads	Prospect/inquiry records — sales pipeline tracking	■	■	22
5	lead_educations	Education history entries per lead	■	■	9
6	applications	University applications — one per university per student	■	■	24
7	student_documents	Files uploaded by/for student per application	■	■	18
8	student_accounts	Fee transactions and running balance per student	■	■	13
9	visa_details	Visa stage tracking per application	■	■	10
10	notifications	Alert records sent to users on events	■	■	9
11	lead_activity_logs	Complete audit trail of all actions on leads	■	■	9

Table Details — All Columns

1. users

Purpose: Login accounts for all roles. role column determines access level.

Column	Type	Key	Description
id	INT	PK	Auto increment primary key
name	VARCHAR(100)		Full name of the user
email	VARCHAR(100)		Login email — must be unique across all users
password_hash	TEXT		Password encrypted with bcrypt — never plain text
role	ENUM		admin / counsellor / student — determines system access
is_active	TINYINT(1)		1 = can login, 0 = account disabled
is_deleted	TINYINT(1)		Soft delete — 0 = exists, 1 = removed from system
profile_image	VARCHAR(255)		File path or URL to profile photo
created_at	TIMESTAMP		When this account was created — auto set
updated_at	TIMESTAMP		Last update time — auto updates on every change

2. counsellors

Purpose: Extra HR details for counsellor staff. Every counsellor has a users record AND a counsellors record linked via user_id.

Column	Type	Key	Description
id	INT	PK	Auto increment primary key
name	VARCHAR(255)		Counsellor full name
father_name	VARCHAR(255)		Father full name
email	VARCHAR(255)		Work email address
phone	VARCHAR(50)		Contact phone number
cnic	VARCHAR(20)		National identity card number
address	TEXT		Home or office address
role	VARCHAR(100)		Always counsellor — role identifier
status	ENUM		active = working, inactive = not available
profile_image	VARCHAR(255)		Profile photo file path
is_deleted	TINYINT(1)		Soft delete flag — 1 means removed
user_id	INT	FK	→ users.id — counsellor login account link
created_at	TIMESTAMP		When counsellor record was created
updated_at	TIMESTAMP		Last update time

3. config_values

Purpose: Master dynamic dropdown table. Replaces all ENUM business fields. One table for all dropdown values across the system.

Column	Type	Key	Description
id	INT	PK	Auto increment primary key

name	VARCHAR(255)		Display name shown in dropdown e.g. Passport Copy, Walk In, IELTS
type	VARCHAR(100)		Category: document_type / lead_source / study_level / english_test_type / degree_type / visa_type
is_active	TINYINT(1)		1 = show in dropdown, 0 = hide — admin can disable without deleting
sort_order	INT		Display order position in dropdown list
user_id	INT	FK	→ users.id — admin who created this config entry
created_at	TIMESTAMP		When this config entry was created
updated_at	TIMESTAMP		Last update time

4. leads

Purpose: Inquiry/prospect records. Created when someone shows interest. Tracks complete sales pipeline from new to success/rejected.

Column	Type	Key	Description
id	INT	PK	Auto increment primary key
name	VARCHAR(100)		Student full name
email	VARCHAR(100)		Student email address
phone	VARCHAR(20)		Student phone number
dob	DATE		Date of birth
marital_status_id	INT	FK	→ config_values.id (type=marital_status) e.g. Single, Married
father_name	VARCHAR(100)		Father full name
father_contact	VARCHAR(20)		Father phone number
home_address	TEXT		Student home address
source_id	INT	FK	→ config_values.id (type=lead_source) e.g. Walk In, WhatsApp, Facebook
preferred_country	VARCHAR(100)		Country student wants to study in
study_level_id	INT	FK	→ config_values.id (type=study_level) e.g. BS, MS, PhD
english_test_id	INT	FK	→ config_values.id (type=english_test_type) e.g. IELTS, TOEFL
english_test_overall_score	DECIMAL(5,2)		Overall English test score e.g. 6.5, 7.0
english_test_scores	JSON		Individual band scores — listening, reading, writing, speaking
counsellor_id	INT	FK	→ counsellors.id — assigned counsellor handling this lead
status	ENUM		new / contacted / counseling / evaluated / applied / visa / success / rejected
profile_picture	VARCHAR(255)		Student photo file path
has_entered_counseling	TINYINT(1)		1 = login account already created for this student
is_deleted	TINYINT(1)		Soft delete — 1 means lead is removed from active list
user_id	INT	FK	→ users.id — admin/counsellor who created this lead
created_at	TIMESTAMP		When lead was first created
updated_at	TIMESTAMP		Last update time

5. lead_educations

Purpose: Education history records per lead. One lead can have multiple entries — Matric, Inter, Bachelors etc.

Column	Type	Key	Description
id	INT	PK	Auto increment primary key
lead_id	INT	FK	→ leads.id — which lead this education record belongs to
degree_id	INT	FK	→ config_values.id (type=degree_type) e.g. Matric, Inter, Bachelors 16yr
year_awarded	INT		Year degree/certificate was completed e.g. 2020
grades_cgpa	VARCHAR(50)		Marks obtained or CGPA e.g. 980, 3.5, A+
board_university	VARCHAR(255)		Name of board e.g. Gujranwala Board or university e.g. PU
user_id	INT	FK	→ users.id — admin/counsellor who entered this education record
created_at	TIMESTAMP		When this record was created
updated_at	TIMESTAMP		Last update time

6. applications

Purpose: University application records. One student can have multiple applications to different universities simultaneously. Personal info fetched from leads

Column	Type	Key	Description
id	INT	PK	Auto increment primary key
target_country	VARCHAR(100)		Country of the target university e.g. Australia, UK
target_university	VARCHAR(255)		Name of university applying to
course	VARCHAR(255)		Program/course name e.g. MS Computer Science
counsellor_notes	TEXT		Internal notes added by counsellor about this application
consultancy_fee	DECIMAL(12,2)		Fee charged by consultancy for this application
status	ENUM		inquiry / evaluation / application submitted / offer letter received / offer letter not received / visa filed
inquiry_date	DATETIME		Timestamp when application entered inquiry stage
evaluation_date	DATETIME		Timestamp when application entered evaluation stage
application_submitted_date	DATETIME		Timestamp when application was submitted to university
offer_received_date	DATETIME		Timestamp when offer letter was received from university
offer_not_received_date	DATETIME		Timestamp when offer letter was not received/declined
visa_filed_date	DATETIME		Timestamp when visa application was filed
approved_date	DATETIME		Timestamp when application was finally approved
reject_date	DATETIME		Timestamp when application was rejected
total_fees	DECIMAL(10,2)		Total university fees for this program
scholarship_amount	DECIMAL(10,2)		Scholarship amount awarded if any
scholarship_type	VARCHAR(100)		Type/name of scholarship awarded
scholarship_remarks	TEXT		Additional notes about scholarship
final_fees	DECIMAL(10,2)		Final fees payable after scholarship deduction
deadline	DATE		Application submission deadline date

student_id	INT	FK	→ users.id — the student this application belongs to
user_id	INT	FK	→ users.id — admin/counsellor who created/manages this
created_at	TIMESTAMP		When application was created
updated_at	TIMESTAMP		Last update time

7. student_documents

Purpose: Files uploaded for applications. is_shared=1 means document belongs to student globally (passport, transcript). is_shared=0 means specific to o

Column	Type	Key	Description
id	INT	PK	Auto increment primary key
application_id	INT	FK	→ applications.id — NULL if is_shared=1 (not app specific)
doc_value	INT	FK	→ config_values.id (type=document_type) e.g. passport, transcript, sop
file_path	TEXT		Full URL or server path to the uploaded file
status	ENUM		pending / review / verified / rejected
uploaded_by	ENUM		student / counsellor / admin — who uploaded this file
uploaded_by_id	INT		User ID of whoever uploaded — matches uploaded_by role
rejection_reason	TEXT		Reason provided when document was rejected by admin
notes	TEXT		Additional reviewer notes about this document
status_history	JSON		Array of previous status changes with timestamps
review_count	INT		How many times this document has been reviewed
reviewed_by	INT		User ID of admin who last reviewed this document
reviewed_at	DATETIME		Timestamp of last review action
is_shared	TINYINT(1)		1 = shared across all applications (passport etc), 0 = app specific
is_deleted	TINYINT(1)		Soft delete — 1 means document removed from view
student_id	INT	FK	→ users.id — the student who owns this document
user_id	INT	FK	→ users.id — admin/counsellor who last acted on it
created_at	TIMESTAMP		When document was uploaded — replaces old uploaded_at
updated_at	TIMESTAMP		Last update time

8. student_accounts

Purpose: Financial transaction ledger. Records all debits (fees charged) and credits (payments made) with running balance per student per application.

Column	Type	Key	Description
id	INT	PK	Auto increment primary key
invoice_no	VARCHAR(50)		Invoice or receipt number e.g. FEE-17, PAY-01
application_id	INT	FK	→ applications.id — which application this transaction is for
transaction_type_id	INT	FK	→ config_values.id (type=transaction_type) e.g. Consultancy Fee, Installment, Refund
debit	DECIMAL(12,2)		Amount charged to student — fee added side of ledger
credit	DECIMAL(12,2)		Amount paid by student — payment received side of ledger
balance	DECIMAL(12,2)		Running balance = total debit minus total credit so far
date	DATE		Date of this transaction
description	TEXT		Free text description e.g. First Installment, Initial consultancy fee
student_id	INT	FK	→ users.id — the student this transaction belongs to
user_id	INT	FK	→ users.id — admin who recorded this transaction

created_at	TIMESTAMP		When transaction record was created
updated_at	TIMESTAMP		Last update time

9. visa_details

Purpose: Visa stage tracking per application. Stores visa type, interview schedule and final visa decision.

Column	Type	Key	Description
id	INT	PK	Auto increment primary key
application_id	INT	FK	→ applications.id — which application this visa belongs to
visa_type_id	INT	FK	→ config_values.id (type=visa_type) e.g. Student Visa, Visit Visa
status	ENUM		pending / approved / rejected
interview_date	DATE		Scheduled date of visa interview appointment
approved_date	DATE		Date visa was officially approved by embassy
student_id	INT	FK	→ users.id — the student applying for this visa
user_id	INT	FK	→ users.id — admin/counsellor managing this visa case
created_at	TIMESTAMP		When visa record was created
updated_at	TIMESTAMP		Last update time

10. notifications

Purpose: Alert records sent to users when events happen. student_id = student receiving it. user_id = any user receiving it.

Column	Type	Key	Description
id	INT	PK	Auto increment primary key
type	VARCHAR(50)		Event type e.g. document_verified, payment_credited, application_updated, lead_assigned
message	TEXT		Full notification message text shown to the user
metadata	JSON		Extra structured data e.g. {applicationId, amount, university, course}
is_read	TINYINT(1)		0 = unread — shows notification badge, 1 = read by user
student_id	INT	FK	→ users.id — student receiving this notification (NULL if not for student)
user_id	INT	FK	→ users.id — any user receiving this notification (admin/counsellor/student)
created_at	TIMESTAMP		When notification was generated and sent
updated_at	TIMESTAMP		Last update e.g. when marked as read

11. lead_activity_logs

Purpose: Complete audit trail of every action on leads. performed_by details fetched via user_id JOIN to users table.

Column	Type	Key	Description
id	INT	PK	Auto increment primary key
lead_id	INT	FK	→ leads.id — which lead this log entry is about
action_type	VARCHAR(50)		What happened e.g. stage_changed, counsellor_assigned, document_uploaded, note_added, pa
from_value	VARCHAR(100)		Previous value before the change e.g. old status, old counsellor name
to_value	VARCHAR(100)		New value after the change e.g. new status, new counsellor name
note	TEXT		Detailed description or message about what happened
user_id	INT	FK	→ users.id — who performed this action (name and role via JOIN)
created_at	TIMESTAMP		Exact timestamp when this action was performed
updated_at	TIMESTAMP		Last update time

config_values — All Types & Values

All business dropdowns are stored here. Admin can add, edit, activate or deactivate any value from the dashboard without code changes.

type value	Used In Column	Sample Values
document_type	student_documents.doc_value	Passport Copy, Academic Transcript, SOP, IELTS Certificate, Passport Photo, Recommendation Letter
lead_source	leads.source_id	Walk In, WhatsApp, Website, Email, Facebook, Google Ads, LinkedIn, Agent, Referral
study_level	leads.study_level_id applications (via leads JOIN)	BS (Bachelor), MS (Master), PhD, Diploma, Certificate, Short Course
degree_type	lead_educations.degree_id	Matric, Inter (12 years), DAE (3 years), ADP (2 years), Bachelors (14 years), Bachelors (16 years)
english_test_type	leads.english_test_id	IELTS, TOEFL, PTE, Duolingo, OET, Cambridge
visa_type	visa_details.visa_type_id	Student Visa, Visit Visa, Work Visa, Dependent Visa, Transit Visa
transaction_type	student_accounts.transaction_type	Consultancy Fee, Installment, Refund, Discount, Processing Fee, Other
marital_status	leads.marital_status_id	Single, Married, Divorced, Widowed
gender	leads (via JOIN to applications)	Male, Female, Other

Foreign Key Map — All Relationships

From Table . Column	References	Relationship Meaning
counsellors . user_id	users.id	Counsellor login account
config_values . user_id	users.id	Admin who created this config entry
leads . marital_status_id	config_values.id	Single / Married / Divorced etc
leads . source_id	config_values.id	Walk In / WhatsApp / Facebook etc
leads . study_level_id	config_values.id	BS / MS / PhD
leads . english_test_id	config_values.id	IELTS / TOEFL / PTE
leads . counsellor_id	counsellors.id	Counsellor assigned to handle this lead
leads . user_id	users.id	Admin/counsellor who created this lead
lead_educations . lead_id	leads.id	Which lead this education entry belongs to
lead_educations . degree_id	config_values.id	Matric / Inter / Bachelors etc
lead_educations . user_id	users.id	Who entered this education record
applications . student_id	users.id	The student this application belongs to
applications . user_id	users.id	Admin/counsellor who created/manages application
student_documents . application_id	applications.id	Which application (NULL if shared doc)
student_documents . doc_value	config_values.id	Document type — passport, transcript, sop etc
student_documents . student_id	users.id	Student who owns this document
student_documents . user_id	users.id	Admin/counsellor who acted on document
student_accounts . application_id	applications.id	Which application this payment is for
student_accounts . transaction_type_id	config_values.id	Consultancy Fee / Installment / Refund etc
student_accounts . student_id	users.id	Student who made/owes this payment
student_accounts . user_id	users.id	Admin who recorded this transaction
visa_details . application_id	applications.id	Which application this visa belongs to
visa_details . visa_type_id	config_values.id	Student Visa / Visit Visa etc
visa_details . student_id	users.id	Student applying for this visa
visa_details . user_id	users.id	Admin/counsellor managing this visa
notifications . student_id	users.id	Student receiving this notification
notifications . user_id	users.id	Any user receiving this notification
lead_activity_logs . lead_id	leads.id	Which lead this log entry is about
lead_activity_logs . user_id	users.id	Who performed this action

Final Standards Summary

Standard	Rule
Table naming	snake_case, descriptive, no tbl_ prefix
Column naming	snake_case, lowercase always
Primary key	Always id — INT AUTO_INCREMENT in every table

Foreign keys	table_name_id suffix e.g. student_id, application_id
Soft delete	is_deleted TINYINT(1) — never hard delete data
Booleans	TINYINT(1) — 0=false, 1=true
Business dropdowns	Always FK to config_values — never ENUM for business data
System status	ENUM only for fixed system values: status, role, uploaded_by
Timestamps	created_at + updated_at in every single table — last columns
student_id	Only in tables where student is the subject of the record
user_id	In every table — the system user who created/performed the action
End sequence (student)	student_id → user_id → created_at → updated_at
End sequence (no student)	user_id → created_at → updated_at
Charset	utf8mb4 — supports all languages, Arabic, Urdu, emojis
Engine	InnoDB — required for foreign keys and transactions